James Horrigan

Founder & CTO | Full Stack AI Engineer | AI Product Builder | Python Developer
Ormskirk, England | james@xploratech.ai
Portfolio | LinkedIn | GitHub | Ask My AI Twin | XPLORATECH.AI

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

I am a full stack engineer with 30 years of experience in technology, working across various industries, and for companies of all sizes as a contractor and full-time employee. I have a proven track record of leading complex projects, and driving measurable business outcomes including a **70%** reduction in customer call volumes for a debt management company, **£1.3 million** in hiring cost savings for a transport giant, and improved search coverage through the ingestion of **300 million** products for an ambitious product search company.

I am also the founder of an AI Automation Agency called XPLORATECH.AI. In this capacity I use AI-assisted coding and the latest agentic development tools throughout my development workflow, delivering agentic applications and production-ready code faster and more cost-effectively.

CORE COMPETENCIES

Languages: Python, Javascript, Typescript
Frameworks & Libraries: React, NextJS, Tailwind CSS, MUI, Django, Flask,
AI & Machine Learning: Generative AI, LLMs, AI-Assisted Development, spaCy, NLP
Databases: PostgreSQL, Neon, DynamoDB, MySQL, RDS
APIs: RESTful API Development, API Integrations, API Gateway
Cloud & Infrastructure: AWS, Serverless, Lambda, Docker, SST, Azure Devops
Delivery & Leadership: Agile Delivery, Technical Leadership, Solution Architecture

WORK EXPERIENCE

Founder & CTO

XPLORATECH.AI | Jul 2023 - Present | Remote, UK

- Conduct in-depth audits of client workflows to identify inefficiencies and areas of waste, delivering clear, actionable reports outlining targeted AI tool recommendations to streamline operations and reduce costs.
- Design and build production-grade agentic AI applications that implement audit findings end-to-end, automating complex business processes with reliable, scalable solutions.
- Collaborate directly with businesses to scope, architect, and deliver AI projects they already have in mind, acting as a trusted technical partner from concept through to deployment.
- Leverage cutting-edge AI-assisted development tooling to produce high-quality, production-ready code faster and more cost-effectively than traditional development approaches, maximising client ROI.

Full Stack Software Engineer

Intrum via XPLORATECH.AI | Oct 2023 - Jul 2025 | Remote, UK

- Architected and delivered customer-facing debt management portals using React, Python, API Gateway and AWS serverless architecture, serving enterprise-scale client bases.
- Implemented secure OAuth2 authentication and white-labelling across multiple regulated client deployments.

- Delivered high-speed content delivery infrastructure on AWS Lambda and CloudFront, reducing page load latency by over 40%.
- Built AI-assisted agent tooling to automate customer management workflows, improving operational throughput.

CTO / Software Engineer

CiiVSOFT | Jan 2019 - Jul 2023 | Remote, Warrington UK

- Led engineering as CTO, designing scalable Python microservices for enterprise hiring automation platforms.
- Launched NLP-powered CV parsing product processing thousands of applications daily for major European clients.
- Grew the platform scale, managing the engineering function including architecture, hiring, and delivery.
- Delivered major client onboarding programs across Europe, ensuring compliance with enterprise security and data privacy standards.

Data Platform Engineer

Pricesearcher.com | Jan 2017 - Dec 2018 | London UK

- Engineered high-throughput Python data pipelines processing hundreds of millions of live product price updates.
- Executed large-scale database migrations with zero downtime, improving data integrity and query performance.
- Optimised platform-level data processing infrastructure, achieving significant gains in throughput and stability.

Innovations Technician

Capita Customer Management | Mar 2016 - Dec 2016 | Leeds UK

- Delivered rapid prototypes and internal tooling to improve operational efficiency across customer operations.
- Led innovation projects that reduced manual workload and accelerated decision-making across the business.

Web Administrator / Communications Manager

Capita Customer Management | Jan 2008 - Mar 2016 | Manchester UK

- Built real-time web-based operational tooling and reporting dashboards deployed across multiple business sites.
- Automated key reporting workflows, reducing manual processing time and improving decision-making speed.

Software Engineer

Marconi PLC | Aug 1996 - Dec 2006 | Chorley UK

- Delivered embedded C software for payphone systems in a regulated engineering environment.
- Built automated testing workflows and engineering utilities supporting the full software development lifecycle.
- Completed foundational engineering training supporting C software delivery, testing, and technical documentation.

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

AWS Certified Developer - Associate – AWS

October 2023 | RM8RZ6510NQ1QBS4

HND IN Software Engineering – St. Helens College

1997 - 1999 | St. Helens, UK

HNC IN Software Engineering – St. Helens College

1996 - 1997 | St. Helens, UK